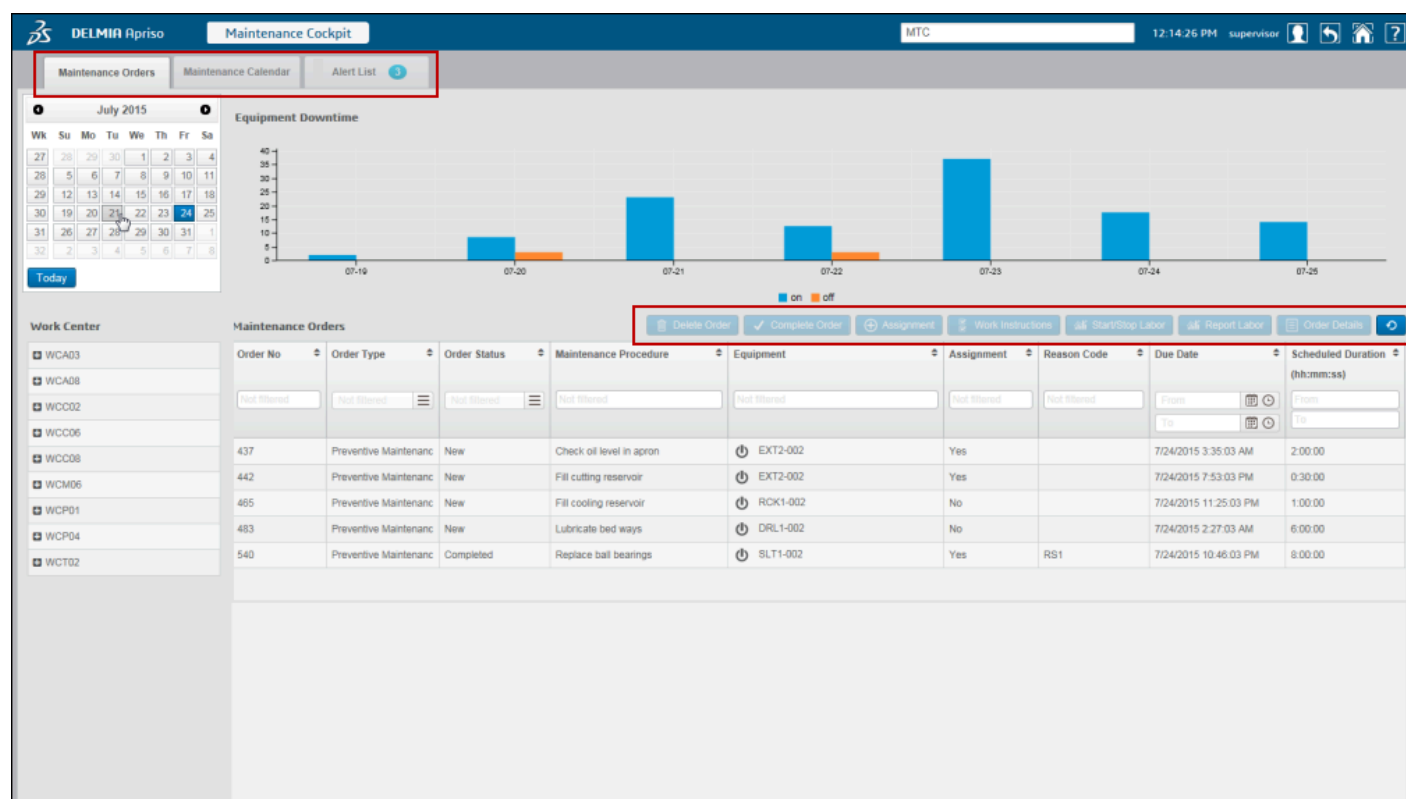


View Action Overview

A View Action is an interactive element which enables moving between Screens and executing business logic.



An Action can be invoked by the following UI events:

- ▶ Clicking a Button or Tab on a Screen
- ▶ Clicking/double-clicking specific places in Business Controls (e.g., on a row on the Grid Control)
 - ▷ For more information, see the **Display Row Selector/Click Mode**, **Row Single Click Mode**, and **Row Double Click Mode** descriptions on the [Grid Properties Tab](#)
- ▶ Reaching the maximum number of characters on the Form control (see [Forms Properties](#))

An Action can:

- ▶ Invoke another action (for details, see [Action Chaining](#))
- ▶ Go to another [Screen](#) (for details on how to create an Action, refer to [Step 3: Define Actions](#))
- ▶ Invoke another [Portal Command](#)
- ▶ Invoke business logic (via a DFC)
 - ▷ A DFC of the Action type can invoke another Action after execution (for more information, see [Action Chaining](#))

On Action DFC/Action Script Function

The following Inputs/Outputs are the same in case of an On Action DFC as well as [Action Script Function](#).

The External Inputs available:

- ▶ **Screen** – the Screen code of the Screen for which the Action is triggered
- ▶ **View** – the View that caused this Action
- ▶ **Action** – the Action
- ▶ Any Portal Session Variable

The External Outputs available:

- ▶ **Action** and **ActionView** – name of the next action to be executed. When an ActionView Output is not empty, an Action will be taken from that View, only names of currently visible View are allowed
- ▶ **ToScreen** and **ToScreenProjectCode** – perform the "Go to Screen" navigation type to any Screen. Outputs contain the name of the Screen and the Project that contain the Screen (if this is a Project entity)
- ▶ All of the variables to be merged into the Portal Session

An Action DFC/Action Script Function can change the Action that was triggered by the View (by returning a new Action in the Action External Output). In this case the defined target Screen will not be navigated to, as the new Action will be analyzed instead. Such analysis will proceed in a loop until the last Action is not changed anymore. This scenario is also known as [Action Chaining](#).

Example configuration

Action	Type	On Action	Go to Screen
NEXT	Button	IsEmployeeValid4WorkCenter_Action	
ACCESS_OK	Calculated		OPP-20
ACCESS_NOK	Calculated	IsThereAnyWorkCenter_Action	WCSELECT-10

If the user presses the NEXT button, IsEmployeeValid4WorkCenter_Action will be called.

The IsEmployeeValid4WorkCenter_Action DFC checks if the employee is valid for the Work Center:

- ▶ If the employee is valid, it will return ACCESS_OK in an External Output Action
- ▶ If the employee is not valid, it will return ACCESS_NOK

The returned Action will be analyzed, and for the Action:

- ▶ ACCESS_OK
 - ▷ This will navigate to the OPP-20 Screen and finish processing
- ▶ ACCESS_NOK
 - ▷ This will call IsThereAnyWorkCenter_Action, which checks if there are any Work Centers configured:
 - ▶ If there are none, it will show an error (via the DisplayError Business Component – for details, see [Errors and Messages Configuration](#)), which will stop the Screen Flows processing
 - ▶ If there are some, it will return an empty Action, in which case the WCSELECT-10 target Screen will appear

This pattern is essential for dividing complex business logic into smaller pieces. Such smaller pieces can be reused later for different logic flows.

On Action DFC

New Entity Wizard

Select the type of entity you would like to create and name it. Click Next to continue.

Entities Types:

Operation DFC Process (deprecated) Screen View Layout Action Script Project

A new Data Flow Control (DFC) which manages the flow of data and its integration with other entities.

Name: SimpleActionDFCName

Subtype: Action

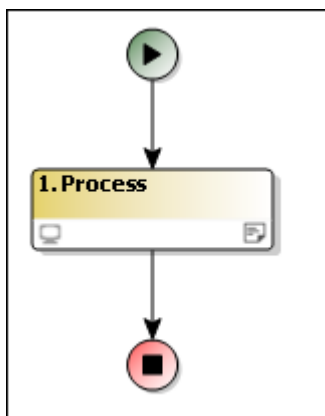
Revision: REV.001.000.____

Project:

Module:

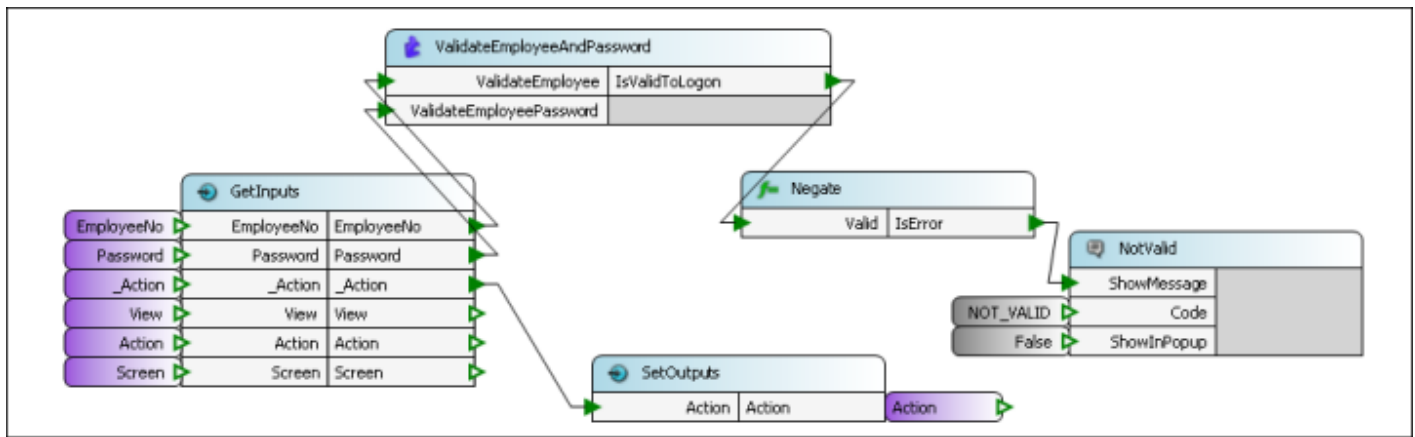
< Back Next > Finish Cancel Help

The structure of an On Action DFC is the following:



An Action DFC (or Action handler) is used to execute the business logic related to a particular event (Action). There are a few requirements for this DFC:

- ▶ It cannot contain a UI element – it should only contain data validation or business logic execution
- ▶ It can return an error (using the **DisplayError** Business Component – for details, see [Errors and Messages Configuration](#))



Action Wildcard

An Action name may contain a wildcard character ("%").

This can be useful in the following example, in which a View DFC can return the following Actions:

- ▶ STATUS_TO_NEW
- ▶ STATUS_TO_CANCEL
- ▶ STATUS_TO_OPEN
- ▶ CLOSE

In this example, all the "STATUS_TO..." Actions should be handled in the same way. Instead of creating three separate Action entries, you can create one entry with a wildcard character: STATUS_TO_%.